

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. With the policy repo rate at 5.25%, the Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate and the Marginal Standing Facility (MSF) rate currently stand at: ★

Ans (D) 5.00% and 5.50%

SDF = repo minus 25 bps (5.00%); MSF and Bank Rate = repo plus 25 bps (5.50%). All were unchanged in the Feb, Apr, Jun and Aug 2026 policies (RBI resolutions).

2. As per the August 2026 MPC resolution, CPI inflation for 2026-27 is projected at: ★

Ans (A) 5.0%

Aug 2026: FY27 CPI projection lowered to 5.0% from 5.1% (June). The 4.3% figure is the core inflation projection (RBI MPC resolution).

3. According to RBI's August 2026 projections, in which quarter of 2026-27 is headline CPI inflation expected to peak, at about 5.9%?

Ans (C) Q3 (October-December)

Aug 2026 path: Q2 4.7%, Q3 5.9%, Q4 5.5%. RBI said inflation will peak in Q3, mainly because of food and fuel (RBI MPC resolution).

4. What are the current Cash Reserve Ratio (CRR) and Statutory Liquidity Ratio (SLR) for scheduled commercial banks? ★

Ans (A) 3.0% and 18%

The CRR was cut 100 bps to 3% in four 25 bps tranches between Sept 6 and Nov 29, 2025. The SLR is 18% of NDTL. Neither headline rate changed in any 2026 policy.

5. Who among the following is NOT a member of RBI's Monetary Policy Committee as of September 2026? ★

Ans (A) Rajiv Ranjan

ED Indranil Bhattacharyya replaced Rajiv Ranjan as RBI's nominee from the Oct 2025 (57th) meeting. The Aug 2026 MPC: Malhotra, Poonam Gupta, I. Bhattacharyya, Nagesh Kumar, Saugata Bhattacharya, Ram Singh.

6. In its August 2026 Statement on Developmental and Regulatory Policies, RBI announced it would resume licensing, largely dormant since 2004, of new: ★

Ans (D) Urban Co-operative Banks

Aug 5, 2026 SDRP: after a two-decade pause, RBI decided to resume 'on tap' licensing of Urban Co-operative Banks and released draft guidelines for comments the same day.

7. According to the RBI Annual Report 2025-26, the size of RBI's balance sheet as on March 31, 2026 was about:

Ans (A) ₹91.97 lakh crore

May 2026: RBI's balance sheet grew 20.61% to ₹91,97,121.08 crore (about ₹91.97 lakh crore) as on March 31, 2026, up from ₹76.25 lakh crore a year earlier (RBI).

8. As per the RBI Annual Report 2025-26, the amount involved in frauds reported by banks during 2025-26 was:

Ans (A) ₹48,021 crore

RBI Annual Report (May 29, 2026): the amount involved in FY26 frauds rose to ₹48,021 crore even as the number of cases fell, pushed up by legacy cases reported afresh.

9. According to the RBI Annual Report 2025-26, counterfeit notes of which denomination were detected in the highest number in the banking system in 2025-26, rising by over 20% over the previous year?

Ans (D) ₹500

RBI Annual Report (May 2026): fake ₹500 notes rose over 20% in FY26 and made up about 61.8% of all counterfeit pieces detected.